

**M1905**

- 1864** Josef Werndl and his brother Franz found their first company (Österreichische Waffenfabriksgesellschaft), which later becomes Steyr-Mannlicher.
- 1867** The Austro-Hungarian Army begins to take delivery of Werndl's breech-loading rifles.
- 1885** Mannlicher's bolt-action rifle is accepted by the Austro-Hungarian Army.

**SSG-69, 1969**

- 1905** The M1905 (see p.168) is popular with Austro-Hungarian army officers, who buy the weapon privately and use it during World War I.
- 1914** On the eve of World War I, Steyr-Mannlicher completes its large new factory building.
- 1915** In a move toward diversification, Steyr begins to manufacture automobiles.

**AUG, 1978**

- 1969** The SSG-69 (see p.252) sniper rifle features a cold hammer-forged barrel and rotary five-round magazine.
- 1978** The Steyr AUG assault rifle (see p.250) is launched; it will spawn a huge number of variants and see very wide service.

curtailed, but in 1950, the company received the go-ahead for the manufacture of hunting rifles. Since then, it has built up an impressive range of weapons for hunters, together with a number of sporting rifles and pistols. When it

▼ MILITARY USE

Some militaries in Southeast Asia use Steyr rifles. Women members of the Royal Malaysian Air Force can be seen marching with Steyr AUG assault rifles during the 48th Malaysian Independence Day celebrations in 2005.

reentered the field of military weapons, it produced a new assault rifle—a “bullpup” design making extensive use of synthetic materials. In Austria, this model became known as the StG 77, while in foreign markets it is the AUG (*Armee Universal Gewehr*) (see p.250). The company has produced this firearm in a range of models, along with sniper rifles such as the Steyr SSG-69 (see p.252); submachine-guns such as the Steyr MPI 81 (see p.274); and

pistols such as the Steyr SPP (see p.271). To take full commercial advantage of these products, Steyr-Mannlicher adapted to the business conditions of the late-20th century by adopting an international approach—licensing production overseas (for example, to Australia and Malaysia) and exporting widely. As a result, the company continues to be a prominent player in the 21st-century firearms market.

